

Changes to the *Assessment Regulations:* 2026-27

Edinburgh Theological Seminary, August 2026

Why We Made These Changes

The Problem

Our regulations had become long, dense, and complex, with 109 separate degree regulation files totalling 185,000 words. Staff and students couldn't easily read or understand the rules around degrees and assessment.

The QAA Targeted Peer Review found inconsistent processes, no institutional training, and no oversight of local handbooks.

What We've Done

Regulations rewritten from the ground up, in plain English, addressed directly to students. 109 files became 4, with an 89% reduction in text.

Substantially simplified rules, standardised processes, sector standards adopted, and better support for students in difficulty. One set of assessment rules at all levels.

What Applies to ETS

BTh

UG Degree Regulations
+ Assessment Regulations

Ordinary undergraduate degree
360 credits, all 10-credit modules

MTh

PGT Degree Regulations
+ Assessment Regulations

Taught postgraduate, 180 credits
Includes 60-credit dissertation

One set of Assessment Regulations covers both programmes

The Assessment Regulations (formerly ‘Code of Assessment’) apply afresh to all students each session. The Degree Regulations apply from entry to the programme.

Terminology

Old term	New term
Code of Assessment	Assessment Regulations
Schedule A	Glasgow Grading Scheme 1 (GGS1)
Schedule B	Glasgow Grading Scheme 2 (GGS2)
Good Cause	Extenuating Circumstances
Credit Refused/Credit Withheld	Retired (no longer used)
Progress Committee	Academic Review Panel
“Resit”	“Reassessment” (avoid “resit”)

Award of Credit

The question award of credit answers

“Should this course count towards the student’s degree?” This is separate from the grade itself and separate from whether the student meets progression or award thresholds.

Course-level credit

Credit for a course when the student achieves D3 or above.

The old 75% submission rule has gone, along with Credit Refused, Credit Withheld, and ECW.

Session-level credit

D3 or above in two-thirds or more of a session’s courses = credit for all courses in the session.

Called ‘compensatory credit’. Failing grades still count in the GPA.

Compensatory Credit: BTh

A BTh student takes 12 modules (120 credits) in a session.

All pass

D3 or above in all 12 modules.

Credit awarded course by course. No compensatory credit needed.

1–4 failures

D3 or above in 8+ of 12 modules (two-thirds).

Compensatory credit: full session counts. Failing grades still in GPA.

Reassessment only if needed for progression.

5+ failures

Fewer than 8 at D3 or above.

No compensatory credit. Reassessment for failed courses, potentially a repeat year.

Advising conversation about support.

Progression and Award

	Progression	Award
BTh	GPA 9.0 per session	GPA 9.0 overall
MTh	GPA 12.0 to dissertation, all credits at D3+	GPA 12.0 with D3+ in dissertation
PG Diploma	—	GPA 9.0 in 120 credits
PG Certificate	—	GPA 9.0 in 60 credits

For BTh: the progress rules are much simpler now

The current multi-threshold system (90 credits after year 1, 180 after year 2, etc.) can be replaced by a single rule: GPA 9.0 per session. The compensatory credit mechanism handles the rest. This also works properly for part-time students without needing separate credit-count provisions.

Reassessment

Only where it makes a difference

Reassessment is offered only where it would change the student's progression or award outcome.

A student who fails one course but whose GPA is above 9.0 may not need reassessment at all, because compensatory credit covers it.

Cap at course level

When a student is reassessed, the cap (D3 for UG, C3 for PGT) is applied to the whole course grade.

Two GPAs

Every student now has:

- First-Attempt GPA – used for classification and endorsement (Merit/Distinction)
- Award GPA – used for progression and award of a degree

Reassessment grades only enter the Award GPA.

Reassessment/Prerequisites

The question:

A student fails Hebrew 1 but otherwise has a good session GPA. They get compensatory credit and can progress generally. But Hebrew 1 at D3+ is a prerequisite for Hebrew 2. What happens?

Reassessment for prerequisites

The Academic Review Panel (or equivalent) can offer reassessment in a specific course so a student can meet a prerequisite, even when their overall GPA is fine.

This decision sits with the Board/Panel, usually not with individual lecturers.

Timing of reassessment

Can reassessment happen between terms so a student can continue their sequence?

Regulations do not prevent this; there is a strong pedagogical case for it with sequential language modules. Just make sure students aren't overloaded or disadvantaged.

Extenuating Circumstances

Stage 1: Do the circumstances qualify?

Assessed by a central team (at Glasgow within Student & Academic Services; at ETS: the office team?).

This is an evidence check, not an academic judgement.

Stage 2: What academic adjustment?

Determined with academic input.

What is the appropriate provision – deferred assessment, cancel-and-retake, other accommodation?

This is the academic decision.

Why?

Consistent treatment of disclosure of difficult/concerning circumstances; access to support/safeguarding; complexity of modern evidence; real or perceived inequities

Extensions

DAPs at Glasgow

Delayed Assessment Permits:

- 3 per student per year
- 5 working days each
- No evidence/rationales needed
- Automated via Moodle
- Coursework only, not exams
- Cannot be stacked

Designed for short-term disruption where students shouldn’t need evidence.

What this means for ETS

DAPs are designed as a very automated system. Students are encouraged to use them to take responsibility for their own life complexities.

ETS currently has its own extension system (3 or 7 days via the course organiser, with Principal approval beyond 7 days). Does this require rationales/evidence?

The question: keep the current system and note in the handbook that AR §16.27 is replaced by ETS’s own arrangements?

EAGR and Appeals

EC After Grade Release (EAGR)

Previously, a student who wanted circumstances considered after grades were released had to appeal. From 2026–27, this is now an EC claim through the EC system, with a higher-level sign off, not an appeal. The evidence bar is higher for EAGR than for a timely claim: the student must show both that the circumstances would have justified a claim and a good reason the claim could not have been made earlier. This means we don’t have the burden of additional appeals, plus have the same set of people considering evidence and applying the same standards for both.

Appeals

The old appeals ground for ‘circumstances not previously presented’ has been removed (replaced by EAGR above). Appeal remains the route where a student believes an accepted EC outcome was misapplied or a procedure was not followed. ETS’s appeals appendix may need updating to reflect these changes?

Merit and Distinction

Glasgow UG thresholds

Merit: GPA 12.0

Distinction: GPA 15.0

(Assessment Regulations §16.35c)

ETS BTh thresholds

Merit: GPA 14.0

Distinction: GPA 17.0

(Matching the PGT thresholds)

Variance

It is fine for ETS to keep its higher thresholds (*lower* would be an issue!). Glasgow may revisit its own in future, so knowing ETS's preference is useful either way.

The MTh Merit/Distinction thresholds are unchanged in substance and now sit in AR §16.38–16.39.

The MTh

The changes for the MTh are lighter than for the BTh. The main points:

Award of credit

Simplified to D3 or above in a course. Old provisions requiring specific numbers of credits at D3+ for PG Dip and PG Cert can be removed – the compensatory credit system replaces them.

Classification

Merit and Distinction thresholds now live in the Assessment Regulations (§16.38–16.39) rather than the Degree Regulations. The thresholds themselves are unchanged. The handbook can cross-reference rather than repeat them.

Progression

GPA 12.0 to progress to the dissertation, with all credits at D3 or above. This is unchanged in substance. The course-level reassessment cap (C3 for PGT) applies.

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